



ANDROID BROWSERS

You will come across several mobile web browsers for Android offering the same core functionality but with a few unique features. According to Statcounter, majority of the mobile web browser users in India (over 55%) use UC Browser whereas Chrome comes in second. Apart from the popular browsers, there are alternatives that provide interesting features often overlooked but equally necessary. It's time that you looked beyond Chrome and your default web browser. Here we try to list down some of these useful features in an effort to make you install one or more browser in your Android phone.



Use in-built browsers

Social media apps and news readers, and in fact almost every app out there are bundling an internal browser to open web links. But these browsers are made just to display the text and no other multimedia content. If you're more interested in only reading the text rather than exploring the photos and videos, then you should opt for the internal browsers which are actually switched on by default.



Doodling on the fly

When you spot something interesting in an online story, the first thing you'd do is take a screenshot and share it on social media. Conventionally, it's a long process where you take a screenshot, then head over to an image editing app, doodle over it and then share it. To make everything super easy, Mercury Browser includes several plugins (we'll be covering a few) such as



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an internal screenshot and doodle function. You can take a screenshot, crop and then doodle over it, and then save the image. Right inside the browser you can navigate to the Files folder of the browser and then share away to wherever you want.



Easily switch between apps and the browser

It's a pain when you have to switch to a browser to open a web link while scrolling through Reddit or Twitter. Flynx works the same way as the chat bubbles for Facebook

Messenger. Every link opens in a pop-up bubble which loads in the background while you continue using the current app. This makes it quicker to switch between the app and the browser rather than having to wait until the entire page loads. You can open up multiple links as well, making it more convenient to open up several links in one go and switching to the browser once you're done scrolling. It has a good looking minimalistic UI and if you're interested, Brave Browser is another one with the same features in a different design.



Adding a passcode to your browser

Not everyone would be comfortable in sharing their browsing history but then you would suggest browsing in the incognito or private mode. But what if you want to save your history without giving anyone access to it? Mercury Browser lets you add a passcode through its privacy options so that all your history is hidden from uninvited users, unless you share your passcode too.



Reading news right in your browser

News buffs already have a separate app dedicated to serve them with news everyday. Since we move towards minimising the number of apps on our phone, UC Browser will be a really useful one for such users. The integration of UC News right inside the browser has ruled out the necessity of installing an extra app for news. It's embedded in the app and appears on the homepage itself. You can browse through various categories such as Cricket, Entertainment, Humour, Gadget etc., and also edit them according to your preferences. The articles open up in optimised windows, putting readability first.

